

And as the chasm between real wealth and faux wealth expands, expectations are violated and misery creeps in. Like a Chinese finger-cuff, the more you try to look rich, the tighter the grip of poorness becomes. Wealth cannot be purchased at a Mercedes dealership, but the destruction of your freedom can.

Lost in wealth's translation is freedom. People flaunt the icons of wealth, but do not have freedom, and when you don't have freedom, it assiduously gnaws at the other true wealth elements, health and relationships.

Henry Sukarano buys his dream house in the Baltimore suburbs for \$1.8 million. As a pharmaceutical representative for one of the leading drug makers, Henry's career is on the fast-track. His big home has everything he wants, including a pool, horse stables, and an impressive five-car garage. The purchase gives Henry a feeling of "I've made it!" . . . for about eight weeks.

Corporate politics and job cuts invade Henry's career, forcing him to work longer hours. He assumes other territories once covered by recently laid-off workers. Henry commutes two hours daily and is mandated to cover the entire Eastern seaboard. He's either on the road, in a plane, or sleeping. The long hours have disturbing clarity: Henry rarely "lives" at his dream home, and when he does, he spends it sleeping or recharging from the hustle of the workweek. His relationship with his wife and kids suffers. His health declines as the stress of responsibility mount.

Henry comes to a moment of truth: "I'm not living a dream, but my dream is living me." Feeling trapped to the lifestyle illusion, Henry continues to work believing the ideology that wealth has its price.

Notice how the destruction of freedom attacks the other sibling wealth components. Unaffordable material possessions have consequences to our health and relationships. The irony of looking wealthy is that it is an enemy to real wealth: *It destroys freedom, it destroys health, and it destroys relationships.*

Foremost, *The Millionaire Fastlane* addresses the FREEDOM portion of the wealth trinity, because freedom offers protection to health and relationships. Only you can define your freedom and how you prefer to live. If you want the freedom to fly private jets, that's it. If you want the freedom to live a minimalist lifestyle, then that is it. Everyone's freedom is different! Within your personal definition, you'll find a big piece of your wealth puzzle, as opposed to society's version, which leads to Sidewalking purgatory.

CHAPTER SUMMARY: FASTLANE DISTINCTIONS

- Wealth is authored by strong familial relationships, fitness and health, and freedom—not by material possessions.
- Unaffordable material possessions are destructive to the wealth trinity.